



ClearExams

CURRENT AFFAIRS

— DAILY DIGEST —

29 SEPTEMBER 2026

POLITY • ECONOMY • SCIENCE
ENVIRONMENT • INDIA & WORLD

J&K ASSEMBLY SEEKS FULL STATEHOOD

RESOLUTION PASSED • 28 SEP 2026



WHAT HAPPENED?

The Legislative Assembly passed the resolution by voice vote after debate.



WHO MOVED IT?

Chief Minister Omar Abdullah



WHAT NEXT?

The resolution will be forwarded to the Government of India for necessary action.



CURRENT STATUS

Jammu & Kashmir remains a Union Territory with a legislature.

2019 REORGANISATION



J&K:
Union Territory
with Legislature



Ladakh:
Union Territory
without Legislature



IMPORTANT: The resolution is a formal political demand — it does not itself restore statehood.

PASHUDHAN BIMA PORTAL

DIGITAL LIVESTOCK INSURANCE • LAUNCHED 28 SEP 2026



ONE INTEGRATED PLATFORM

Online application • Policy issuance • Claim processing
• Monitoring • Reporting



WHO RUNS IT?

Department of Animal
Husbandry & Dairying



FARMER ACCESS

Apply online and
track the insurance
process digitally



LANGUAGE ACCESS

Hindi + English +
11 regional languages



WHY IT MATTERS

Transparent service
delivery • Real-time
monitoring • Better
coordination • Livelihood
protection



CURRENT AFFAIRS • AGRICULTURE & DIGITAL GOVERNANCE

PRAHAAR

NATIONAL CT POLICY & STRATEGY

CONFERENCE INAUGURATED • 28 SEP 2026

SEVEN-PILLAR FRAMEWORK

- 1 Prevention
- 2 Response
- 3 Aggregating Internal Capacities
- 4 Human Rights
- 5 Attenuating Conditions for Terrorism
- 6 Aligning International Efforts
- 7 Recovery & Resilience

WHOLE-OF-SOCIETY APPROACH

NEW EXTRADITION PORTAL

Designed to coordinate and speed up efforts to bring fugitives back from abroad.

2019–2026

288 FUGITIVES BROUGHT BACK
FROM **36** COUNTRIES

EXAM LENS

Counter-terror coordination • UAPA • Extradition • Centre–State policing

INDIA-UAE

LOCAL-CURRENCY TRADE

14TH HIGH LEVEL JOINT TASK FORCE • 28 SEP 2026



WHAT WAS AGREED?



Trade settlement
in local currencies



Integration of payment
& messaging systems



Cooperation on
central-bank digital
currencies



FASTER



• MORE ACCESSIBLE •



MORE RESILIENT

TRADE SNAPSHOT



\$101.25 BILLION

BILATERAL TRADE • FY 2025-26



\$76.2 BILLION

NON-OIL TRADE • 2025

2032 TARGET



\$200 BILLION

BILATERAL TRADE



India-UAE Joint Task Force on Investments was established in 2013.

EXAM LENS



Local-currency settlement • Cross-border payments • CBDCs • CEPA

KAVACH 4.0

RAIL SAFETY EXPANSION

VARANASI DIVISION • APPROVED 28 SEP 2026



614.75
ROUTE KILOMETRES



₹223 CRORE
APPROVED OUTLAY

WHAT IS KAVACH?

India's indigenous Automatic Train Protection system.



PREVENTS SPAD

Signal Passing at Danger



AUTOMATIC BRAKING

Applies brakes when required



TRAIN MONITORING

Supports safer train movement



NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY • VARANASI DIVISION



WHY THIS APPROVAL MATTERS



Covers identified balance sections



Strengthens train-protection infrastructure



Supports safer and more reliable operations



EXAM LENS

Indigenous technology • Railway safety • ATP • Modernisation

FASTag **ANNUAL PASS** **CROSSES 1 CRORE**

MILESTONE ANNOUNCED • 28 SEP 2026

1 CRORE

PASSES ISSUED

Launched on 15 August 2025



HOW THE PASS WORKS



₹3,075
ONE-TIME FEE



1 YEAR
VALIDITY



200
TOLL-PLAZA
CROSSINGS

WHICHEVER LIMIT IS REACHED FIRST

COVERAGE & ELIGIBILITY



ABOUT 1,150
FEE PLAZAS



NON-COMMERCIAL VEHICLES
WITH A VALID FASTag

Activated on the vehicle's existing FASTag through the Rajmargyatra App.



EXAM LENS

Digital tolling • RFID • National Highways • User-fee policy

RABI CAMPAIGN 2026

Climate-resilient planning from seed to market



WATER FIRST

States and districts must assess irrigation water and soil moisture before fixing crop plans.



Low-water areas: prioritise pulses & oilseeds



MARKET ASSURANCE

Procurement must be planned with production.

NAFED + NCCF



Can procure directly if States cannot act on time



WEEKLY MONITORING

Track sowing, germination, pests, diseases and market prices for early action.



DROUGHT RESPONSE

Central assessment team to visit Karnataka on 3 October; a team will also be sent to Maharashtra.



EXAM LINKS

PSS • AgriStack • KVKs • crop diversification • Centre–State coordination

KAZIND 2026

India–Kazakhstan Joint Military Exercise



28 SEP — 11 OCT 2026



OSKEMEN, KAZAKHSTAN



WHO PARTICIPATES?

60-member Indian contingent

Mainly GARHWAL RIFLES, with other arms, services and Indian Air Force personnel



Kazakh contingent: matching strength



CORE AIM

**Interoperability
for joint
counter-terrorism
operations**

Sub-conventional environment •
United Nations mandate



TRAINING TERRAIN

Semi-urban + mountainous

Joint planning,
execution and
air mobility



TECH FOCUS

**Unmanned Aerial
Systems
Counter-UAS
capabilities**

Integrated
employment
during operations



REMEMBER

Partner: **Kazakhstan** • Venue: **Oskemen** • Edition: **9th**

UPI MDR CASE

Supreme Court declines interim stay



Specified P2M payments above ₹2,000
Framework scheduled from 15 OCT 2026



COURT'S DECISION

No interim stay granted

The challenged MDR framework is not paused at this stage.



WHAT IS MDR?

Merchant Discount Rate

A charge linked to merchants accepting digital payments.



NEXT STEP

Replies due within 4 weeks

Centre and other respondents must file counter-affidavits.



IMPORTANT NUANCE

The case remains pending

Refusing a stay is not a final ruling on validity.



EXAM TERMS

UPI • P2M = Person-to-Merchant • interim relief • counter-affidavit

DELHI ELECTORAL ROLL REVISION

ECI extends key SIR deadlines

01 REVISED TIMELINE



- Claims & objections: till **30 OCT 2026**
- Disposal of notices and claims: till **30 NOV 2026**

02 DOORSTEP PROCESS



- BLOs will visit noticees to collect documents
- Documents will be uploaded on ECINet

03 HEARINGS



- Only in exceptional cases
- Preferably online
- An adult family member may represent the elector

04 INCLUSION SAFEGUARDS



- Special enrolment drives and help desks
- Focus on omitted electors, homeless persons, labourers and people in night shelters



CONSTITUTIONAL ANCHOR

Article 324: Superintendence, direction and control of elections vest in ECI

Electoral rolls: Representation of the People Act, 1950

INDIA AT COFO 28

Forest & Landscape Restoration Commitments

FAO Committee on Forestry • Rome • 28 SEP–2 OCT 2026



FOREST SNAPSHOT

82.74
MILLION
HECTARES

Forest and tree cover
25.17% of India's
geographical area



GLOBAL POSITION



9th globally
in forest area

3rd in net annual
forest-area gain

FAO Global Forest
Resources Assessment 2025



BONN CHALLENGE

Target: Restore
26 million
hectares
by 2030

Progress:
21.76 million
hectares
under restoration



CLIMATE COMMITMENT

Additional carbon sink created
by 2021:

2.29 BILLION
TONNES CO₂e

2035 ambition:

3.5–4.0 BILLION
TONNES CO₂e

compared with 2005 levels

RESTORATION INITIATIVES



Aravalli Green Wall:
6.45 million hectares identified



MISHTI:
Mangrove restoration, climate resilience
and livelihoods

CBDT EXTENDS TAX FILING DEADLINES

Assessment Year 2026–27 • Audit Cases



AUDIT REPORT

OLD DEADLINE



30 SEPTEMBER 2026

NEW DEADLINE



21 OCTOBER 2026



RETURN OF INCOME

OLD DEADLINE



31 OCTOBER 2026

NEW DEADLINE



21 NOVEMBER 2026



WHO IS COVERED?

Persons subject to audit
under the Income-tax Act, 1961

Section 139(1) • Explanation 2 •
Serial No. 2



WHAT THE ORDER DOES

Extends both:

- “Specified date” for audit report
- Due date for Return of Income

A formal order or notification
is to be issued separately

INSTITUTIONAL MAP



CBDT



Department of Revenue



Ministry of Finance

INDIA'S TELECOM SNAPSHOT

Subscription Data • August 2026



TOTAL TELEPHONE

1,360.70
MILLION
Subscribers



Net addition: **6.42 million**

Monthly growth: **0.47%**



BROADBAND

1,101.21
MILLION

Up from **1,094.48 million**
in July



Monthly growth: **0.61%**



ACCESS MIX

Wireless:
1,312.25 million

Wireline:
48.45 million

Fixed Wireless
Access growth: **2.68%**



URBAN-RURAL

Urban:
802.28 million

Rural:
558.43 million

Urban share:
58.96%



DATA SOURCE

Telecom service providers report subscription data to TRAI
Broadband figures include M2M cellular connections

INDIA'S FIRST PRAMAAN CERTIFICATES

Forest & Wood Certification



29 SEP 2026 • 14:57 IST



WHAT HAPPENED

First PRAMAAN certificates were handed over under India's national forest-and-wood certification framework.



FIRST RECIPIENTS

- Andhra Pradesh Forest Development Corporation
- A bamboo farmer from Odisha



THE SCHEME

Voluntary • Third-party • Market-based



3 CERTIFICATION TRACKS

1

Forest Management



2

Trees Outside Forests



3

Chain of Custody



INSTITUTIONAL MAP

Council: Indian Forest & Wood Certification Council

Operator: Indian Institute of Forest Management, Bhopal

Accreditation: NABCB under Quality Council of India



WHY IT MATTERS

Promotes sustainable forestry, agroforestry and traceable wood supply chains.

INDIA STRENGTHENS ITS STATISTICAL BUSINESS REGISTER

MSME–MoSPI DATA PARTNERSHIP

29 SEP 2026 • 15:40 IST



THE DEVELOPMENT

Ministry of MSME and MoSPI signed an MoU to institutionalise data sharing for strengthening the Statistical Business Register.

THE DATA FLOW



**UDYAM
REGISTRATION**

→ Structured
data sharing



**STATISTICAL
BUSINESS REGISTER**



WHAT IS AN SBR?

A continuously updated statistical database of business establishments and enterprises.



WHY IT MATTERS

- Better coverage of MSMEs
- More consistent business statistics
- Reliable frames for economic surveys
- Stronger evidence-based policymaking



KEY DISTINCTION

Udyam is an MSME registration ecosystem.

SBR is maintained for statistical and analytical purposes.



INSTITUTIONS

MSME Ministry: Udyam data source

MoSPI / NSO: Official statistics system

INDIA'S SERVICES OUTPUT GAUGE

July 2026 trial ISP released



WHO COMPILES IT?

National Statistics
Office (NSO), MoSPI



WHAT IT MEASURES

Short-term changes
in formal services
output



BASE YEAR

2024-25



COVERAGE

19 sub-sectors •
about 60% of services



ISP
Services

IIP
Industry

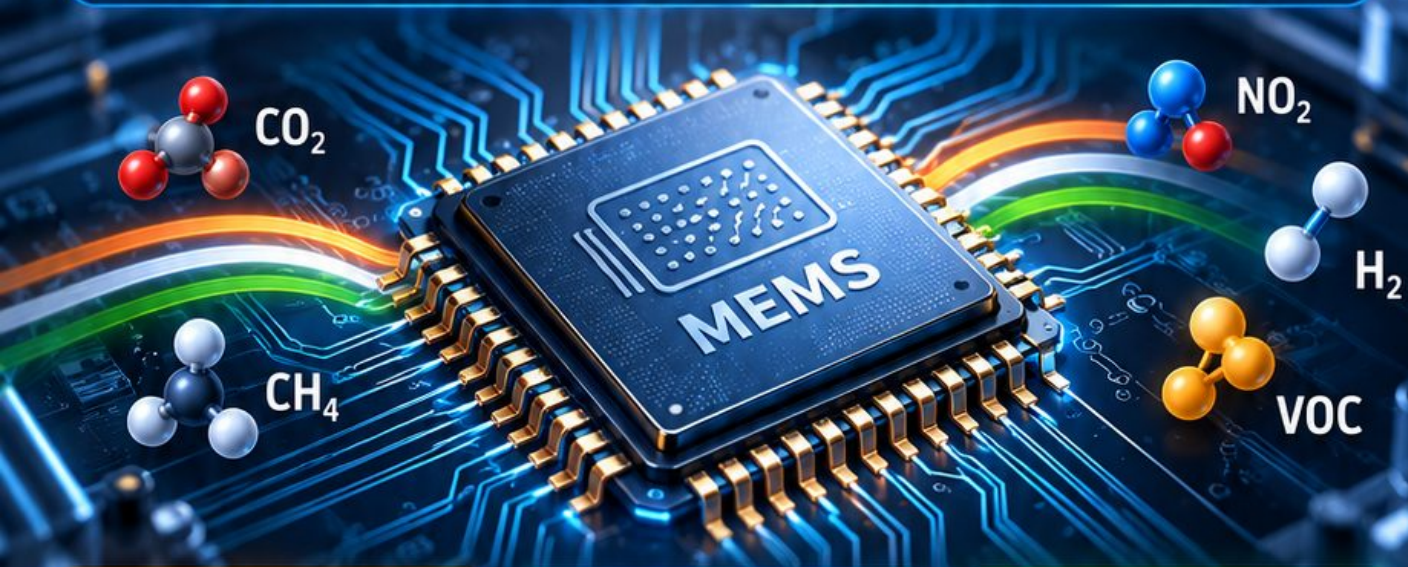


Trial series • Monthly release • Overall composite index to follow
after wider coverage and stability checks

INDIGENOUS MULTI-GAS SENSOR PLATFORM

₹37.51 CRORE RDI SUPPORT

TDB agreement with Multi Nano Sense Technologies



CORE TECHNOLOGY

MEMS gas sensors +
AFE system-on-chip



GOAL

Design and
manufacture the
platform in India



WHY IT MATTERS

Miniaturised •
Low-power •
Multi-gas detection



MEMS SENSOR



AFE SoC



SMART SENSING
PLATFORM

APPLICATIONS



Industrial safety



Air-quality
monitoring



Hydrogen
systems



Smart devices

PRAGATI-50

50 MODEL CITIES FOR SWACHHATA



LAUNCHED: 29 SEPTEMBER 2026



WHAT IT DOES



Develops a replicable Model City framework for urban cleanliness

COVERAGE



50 cities across 24 States

IMPLEMENTATION



Outcome-based reviews • Digital monitoring • Review every two months

TECHNOLOGY SUPPORT



Swachh Bharat Test Bed launched by CSIR-CMERI



EXAM CONTEXT



SBM-Urban 2.0



Vision: Garbage-Free Cities



Focus: sanitation • solid waste • used-water management



29 SEPTEMBER 2026 • 18:54 IST

CAQM REVISES **GRAP**

Delhi–NCR gets tighter pollution controls



WHAT HAPPENED

CAQM approved a revised Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP), strengthening action on vehicles, construction dust and other pollution sources.

THE 4 AQI STAGES

I

POOR
201–300

II

VERY POOR
301–400

III

SEVERE
401–450

IV

SEVERE+
Above 450



WHY IT MATTERS

- GRAP is an emergency, graded response linked to Delhi's air quality.
- Measures intensify as AQI worsens.
- CAQM coordinates action across the National Capital Region.



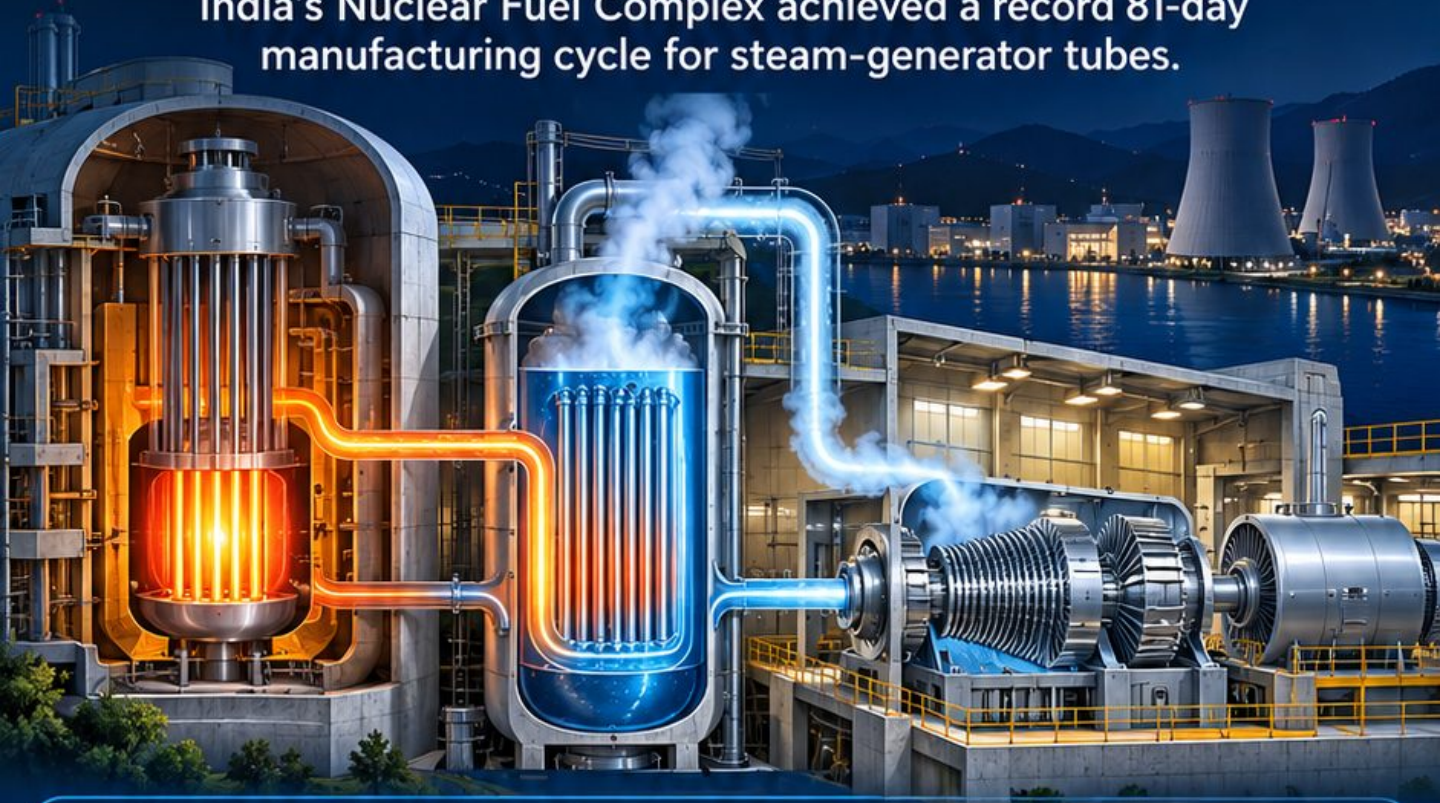
INSTITUTION CHECK

CAQM = Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR and Adjoining Areas

Statutory body under the CAQM Act, 2021

NUCLEAR MANUFACTURING NFC SETS AN **81-DAY** RECORD

India's Nuclear Fuel Complex achieved a record 81-day manufacturing cycle for steam-generator tubes.



WHY THESE TUBES MATTER

- Transfer reactor heat to water that becomes steam
- Steam drives the turbine-generator
- Demand extreme precision, inspection and corrosion resistance

INDIA'S NUCLEAR SUPPLY CHAIN NFC, Hyderabad

Industrial unit of the Department of Atomic Energy.



SUPPORTS INDIGENOUS PHWRs

NFC manufactures steam-generator and heat-exchanger tubes for Pressurised Heavy Water Reactors.



EXAM FACTS



PHWR = Pressurised Heavy Water Reactor

NFC also supplies nuclear fuel and reactor-core components.

VIKSIT PANCHAYAT

Connecting people, places, resources & opportunities



People



Livelihoods
and opportunity



Local resources
and land



Government
programmes



WHAT HAPPENED

NITI Aayog organised a national workshop under its State Support Mission, with the Government of Assam.



WHERE & WHEN



Assam Administrative
Staff College, Guwahati



28 September 2026



GOVERNANCE IDEA

- Stronger grassroots planning
- Link people, local resources and opportunities
- Better convergence across departments and programmes



PANCHAYATI RAJ — EXAM CHECK



PART IX

Constitutional
framework for
Panchayats



73rd AMENDMENT

Constitutional
status from 1993



11th SCHEDULE

29 subjects for
possible devolution



STATE SUPPORT MISSION

NITI Aayog initiative supporting States and Union Territories in achieving development goals.